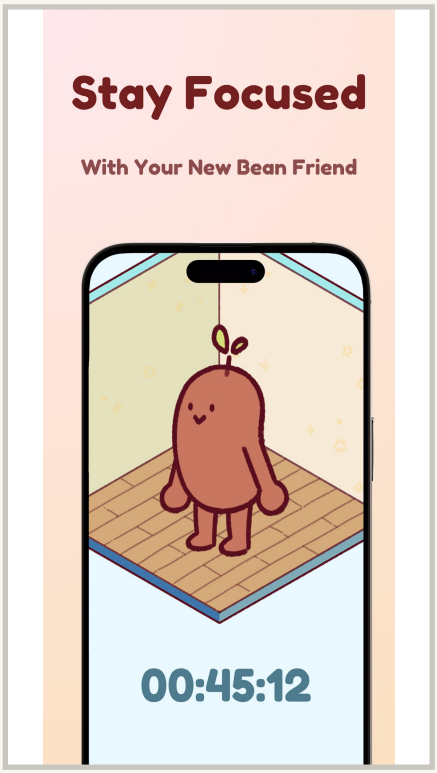
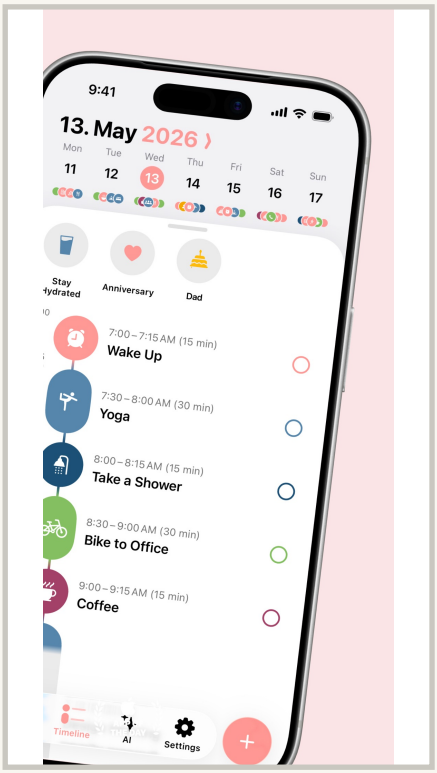
20 APP UX PATTERNS

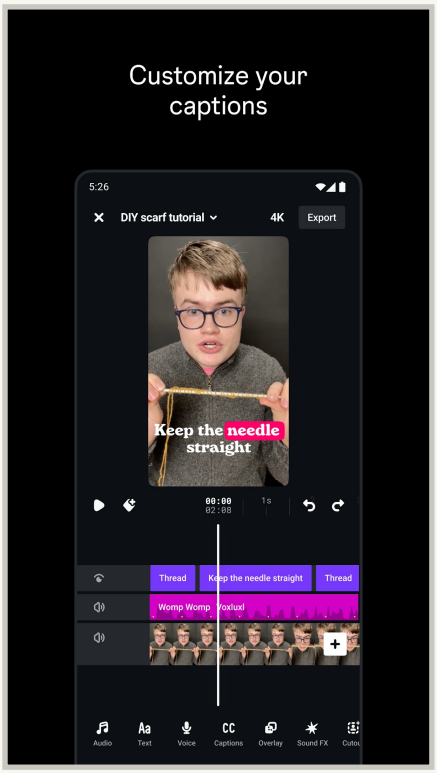
A visual study of interface decisions worth borrowing.



FOCUS FRIEND



STRUCTURED



EDITS

Look at the screen.
Then look at the move.

Every case begins with a screenshot from the app's official store listing. The orange frame marks the part discussed in the analysis. Use the zoom to inspect it, then test the idea against your own users and constraints.

01 SEE

Read the full screen first. Notice what is prominent, hidden, or sequenced.

02 UNDERSTAND

Use the orange focus and zoom to connect the written observation to a visible UI detail.

03 TRANSFER

Treat the principle as a hypothesis. Sketch a version for your product and test it.

FIVE CHAPTERS

01 One Clear Promise
02 Complex Work, Simple Flow
03 Data That Leads To Action
04 Design For More People
05 Interaction Built Around The Task

ONE CLEAR PROMISE

grug

Daily wisdom / iOS

Make the first useful action obvious.



grug.

first thought when wake = seed for whole day. grug plant one small good thought, grow good day tree.

VISUAL SIGNAL

One thought occupies the reading view.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Open, read one thought, leave. Notice the hand-drawn interface and absence of account setup.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Reduce the first session to one useful outcome before asking for a profile.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

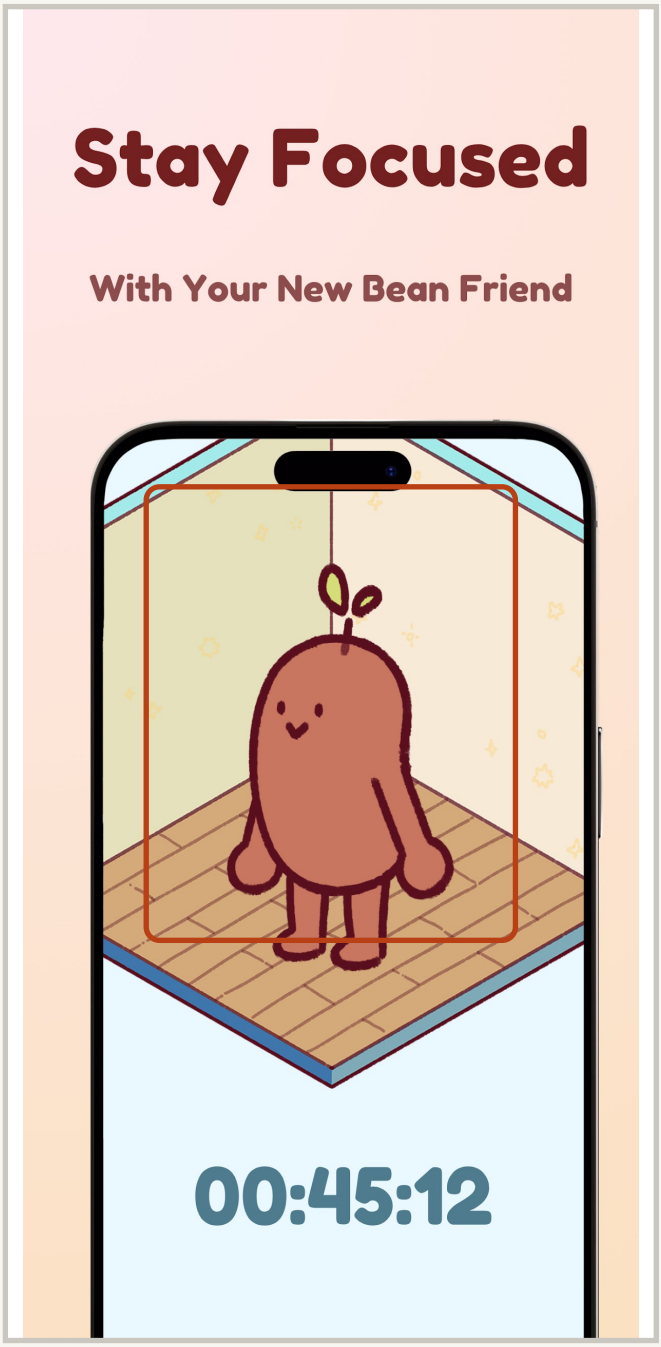
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

ONE CLEAR PROMISE

Focus Friend

Focus timer / Android

Make the first useful action obvious.





VISUAL SIGNAL

The friend and timer make focus tangible.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

A small character turns a focus session into a reason to put the phone down.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Let the reward reinforce the user's real goal, not screen time.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

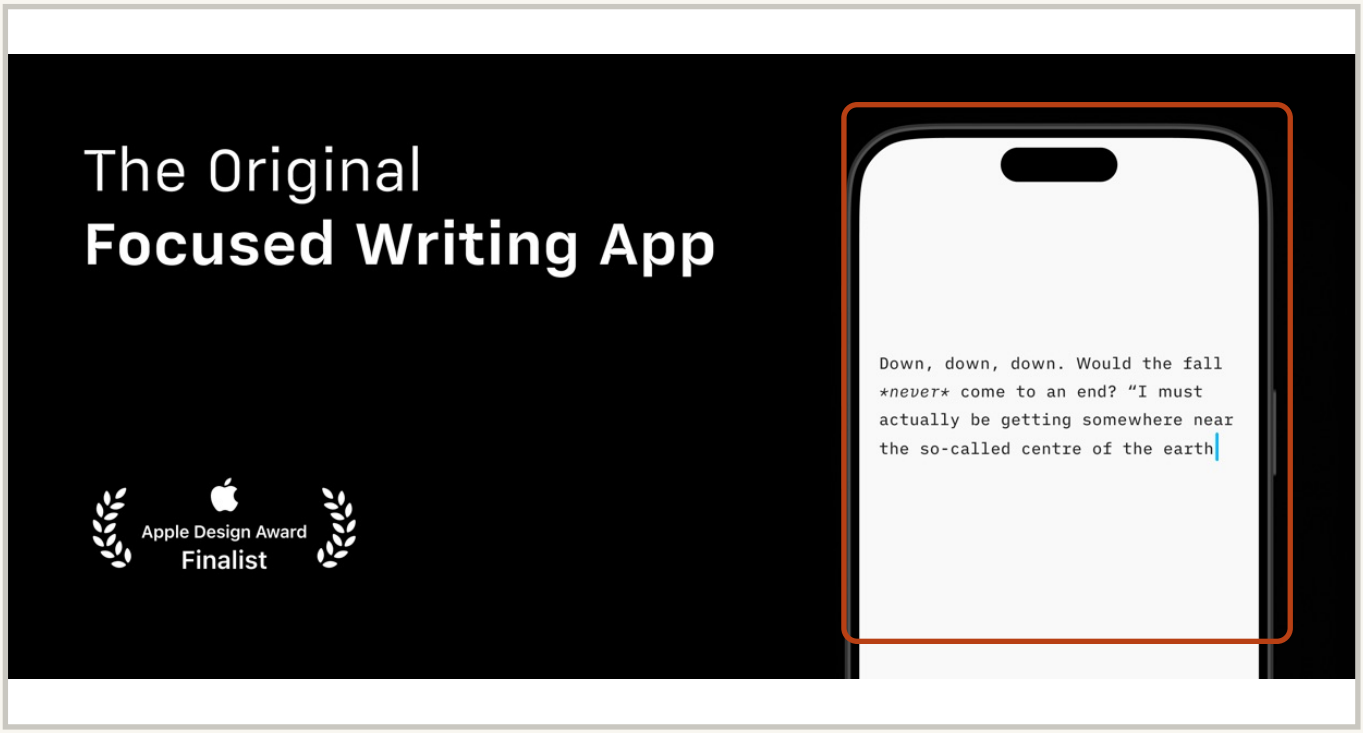
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

ONE CLEAR PROMISE

iA Writer

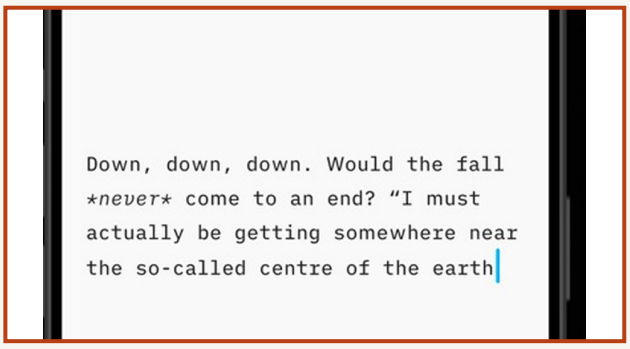
Writing / iOS

Make the first useful action obvious.



VISUAL SIGNAL

A plain writing surface keeps attention on words.



WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

The editor removes most interface chrome and gives the draft a quiet, central surface.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Hide secondary tools until the user is ready to switch tasks.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

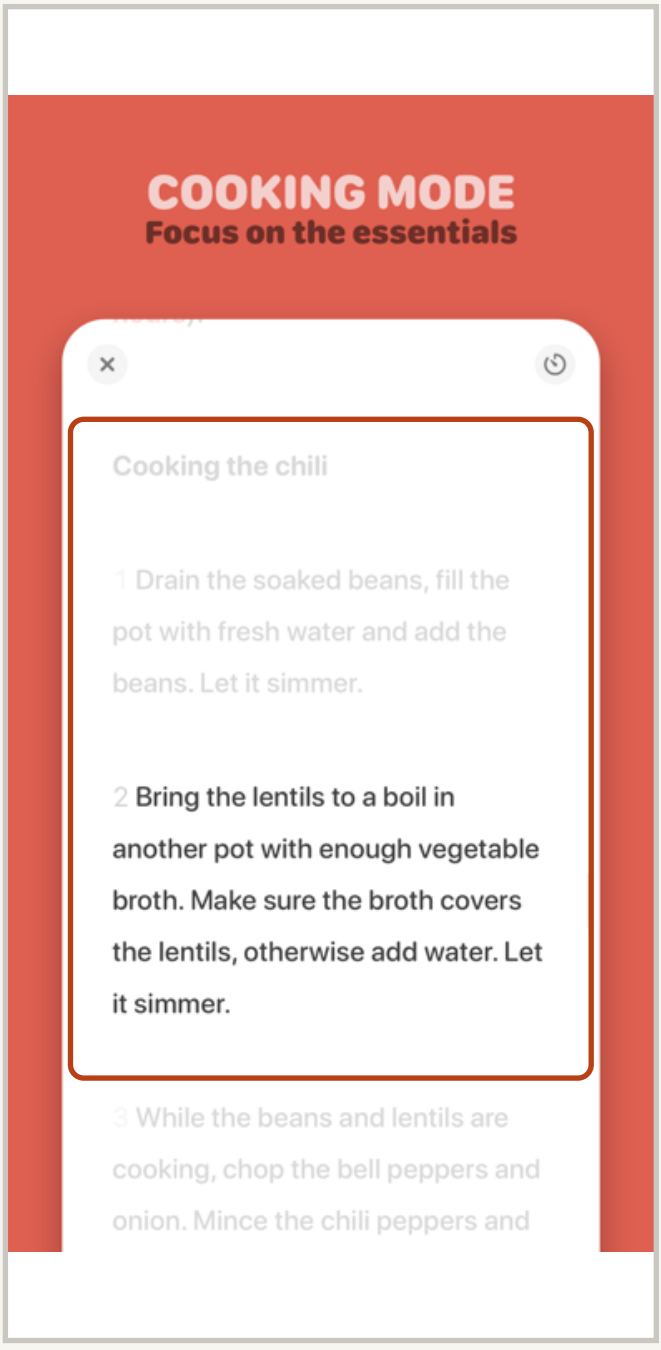
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

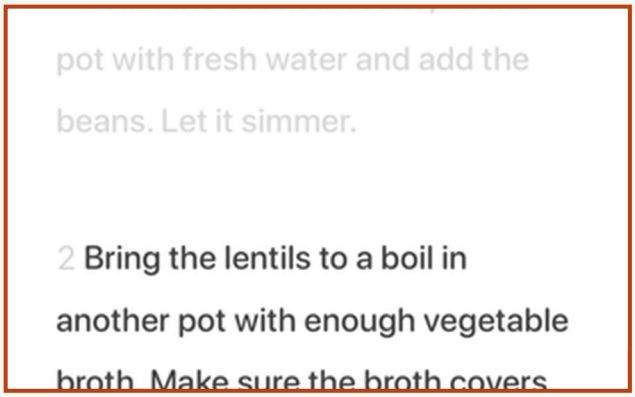
ONE CLEAR PROMISE

Mela

Recipe manager / iOS

Make the first useful action obvious.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Cooking mode foregrounds the current step.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Cooking mode emphasizes the current step while timers remain close at hand.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Design around the moment of use, not just the content catalog.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

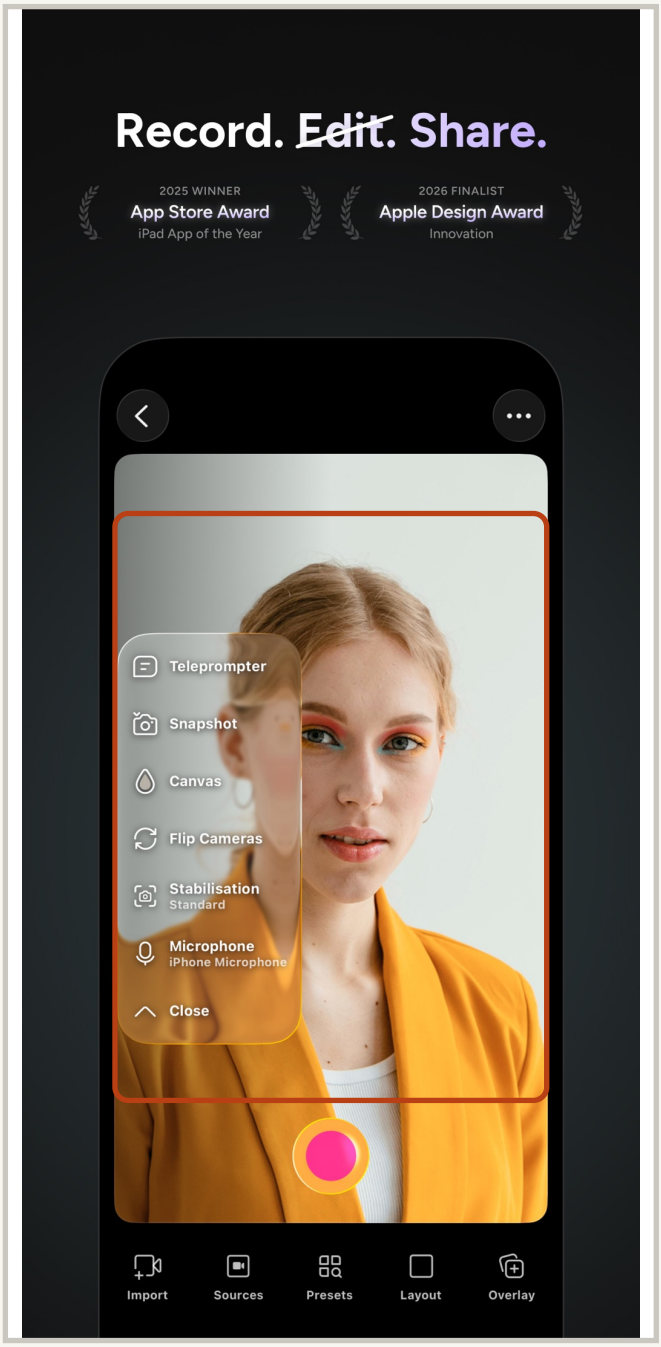
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

COMPLEX WORK, SIMPLE FLOW

Detail

AI video editor / iOS

Show the result, then reveal the power underneath.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Recording and editing start in one flow.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Record, edit and share are presented as one sequence around a familiar camera view.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Give beginners a short path to a finished artifact; keep advanced editing available.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

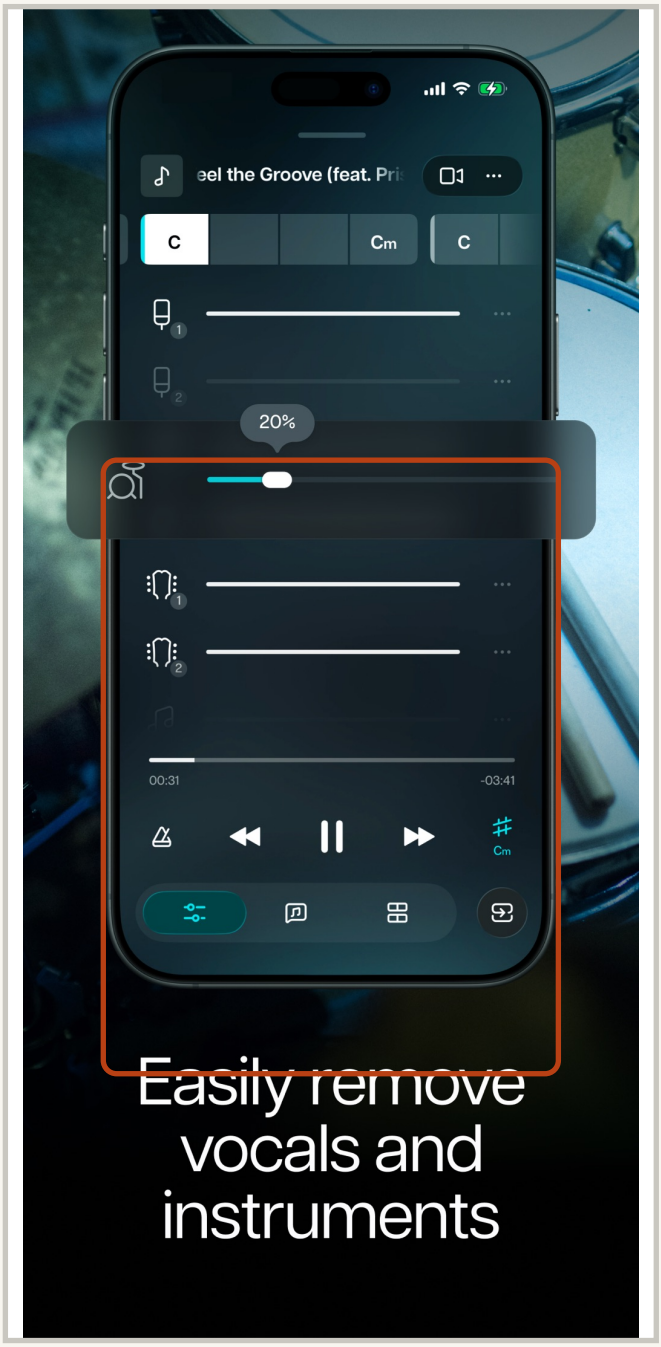
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

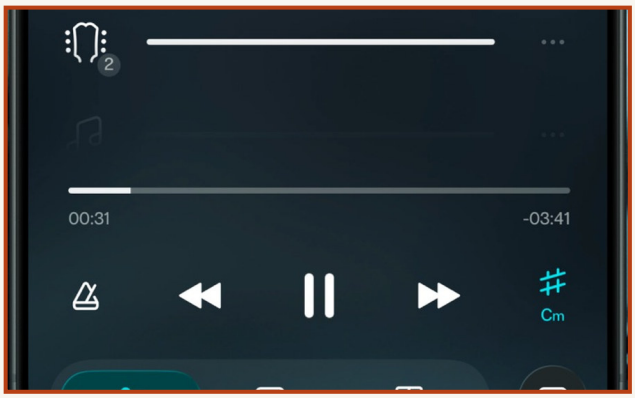
COMPLEX WORK, SIMPLE FLOW

Moises

Music creation / iOS

Show the result, then reveal the power underneath.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Vocals and instruments become separate tracks.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Stem separation becomes a visible, playable set of tracks rather than an abstract AI feature.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Make an invisible model output tangible and reversible.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

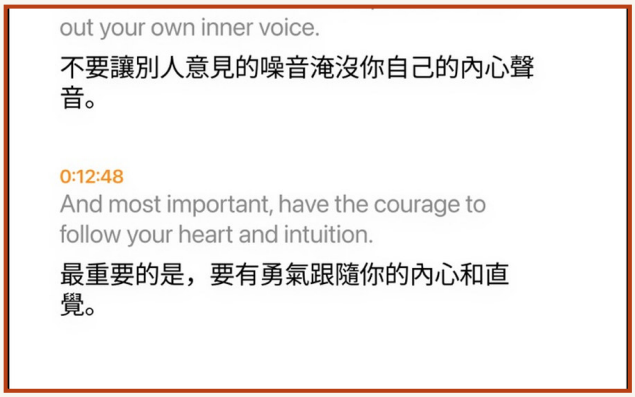
COMPLEX WORK, SIMPLE FLOW

Capy

Meeting translation / iOS

Show the result, then reveal the power underneath.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Transcript and translation share the screen.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Transcript and translation are placed in a readable view as the conversation unfolds.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Keep the useful output visible while processing is in progress.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

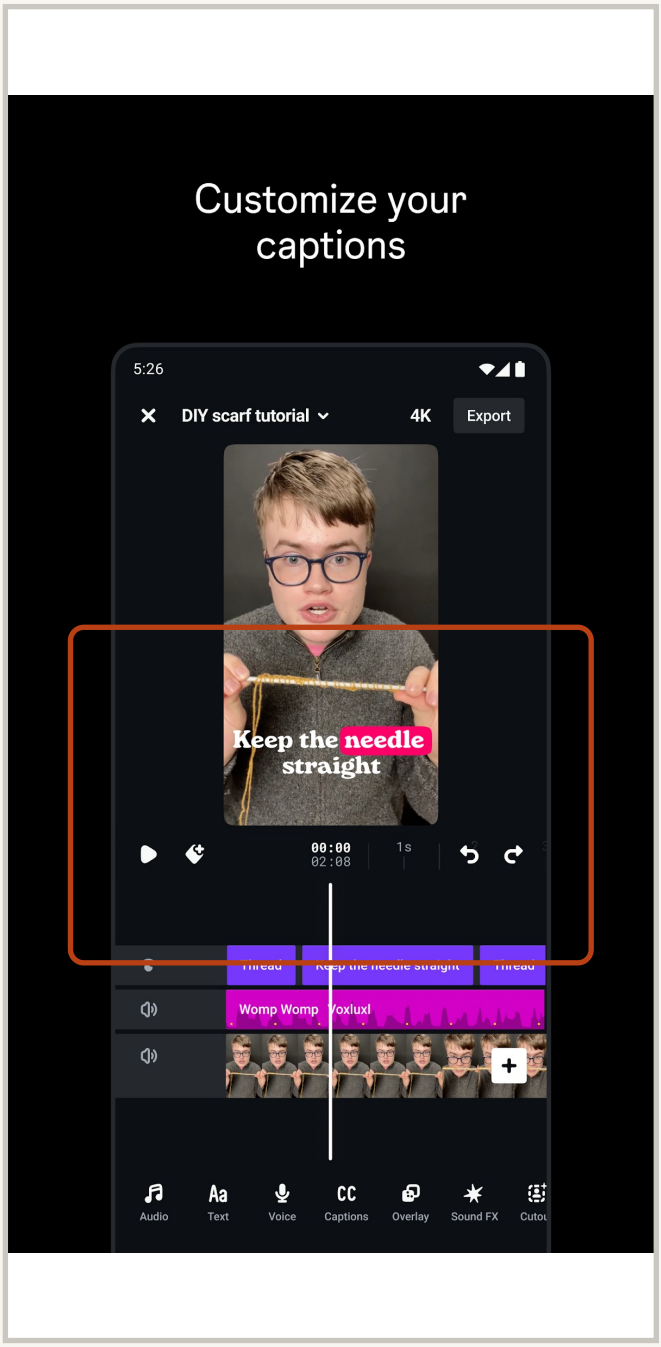
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

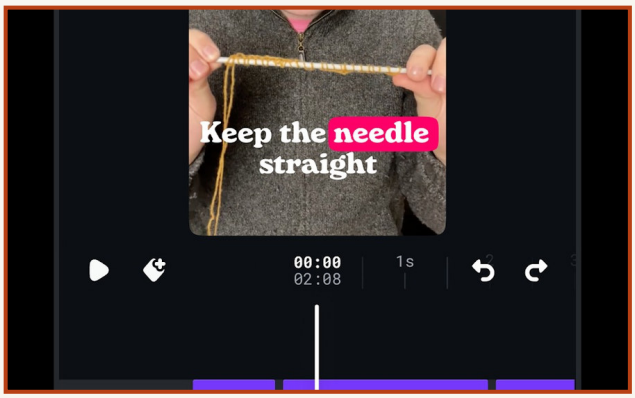
COMPLEX WORK, SIMPLE FLOW

Edits

Mobile video editor / Android

Show the result, then reveal the power underneath.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Clips, captions, and tools share one timeline.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

The editor puts video preview, captions, timeline and tools in one vertical workflow.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Organize tools in the order of the creator's job, not by technical feature type.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

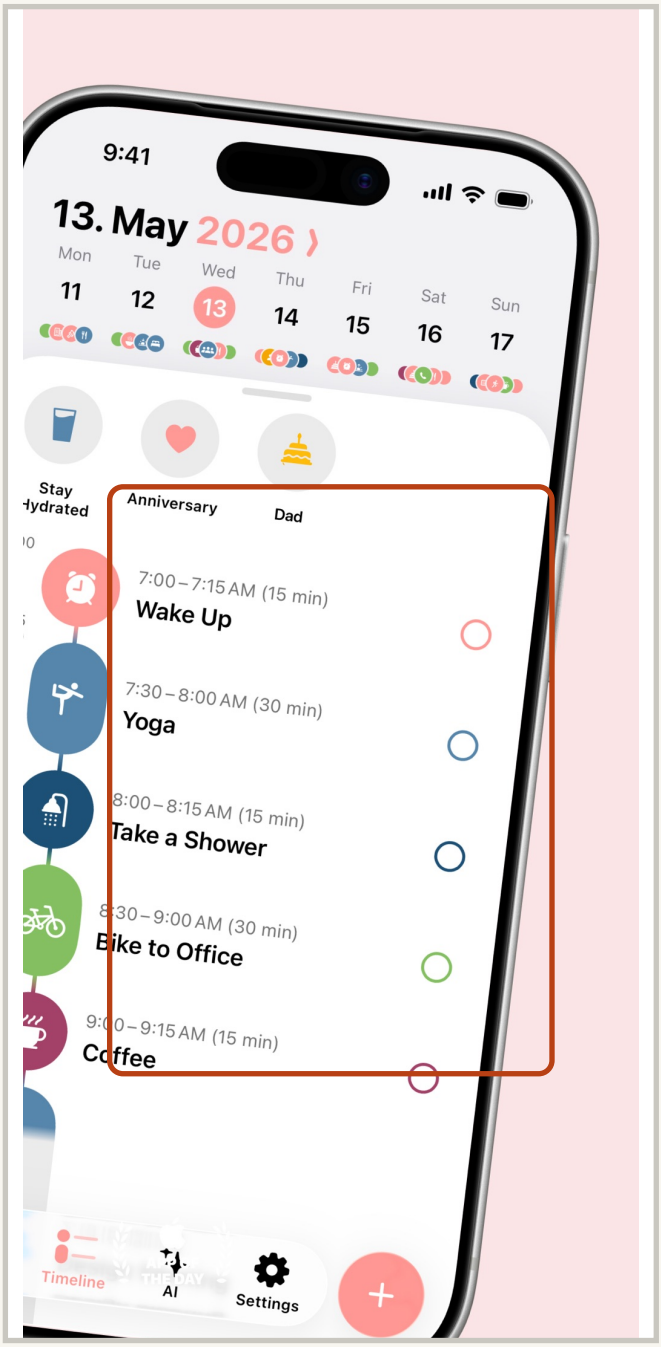
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

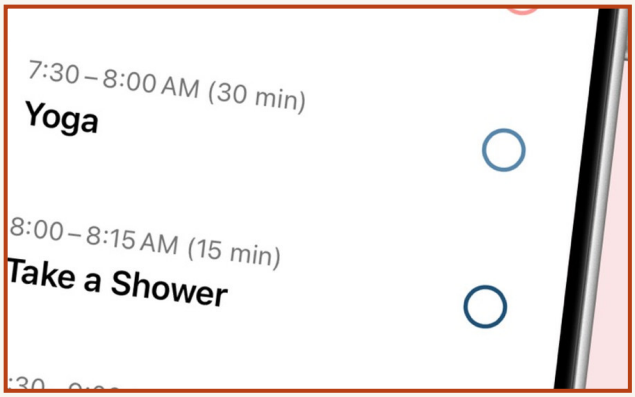
DATA THAT LEADS TO ACTION

Structured

Daily planner / iOS

Turn information into a next step.





VISUAL SIGNAL

A vertical timeline shows the shape of the day.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

A scannable timeline makes tasks, free time and breaks visible together.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Show capacity and recovery alongside commitments.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

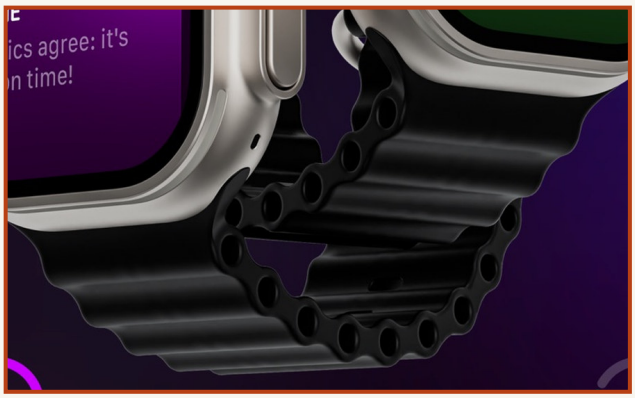
DATA THAT LEADS TO ACTION

The Outsiders

Athlete tracker / iOS

Turn information into a next step.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Training signals resolve into a readiness view.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Training load, sleep and recovery combine in one readiness view.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Translate several metrics into a decision cue, while keeping detail inspectable.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

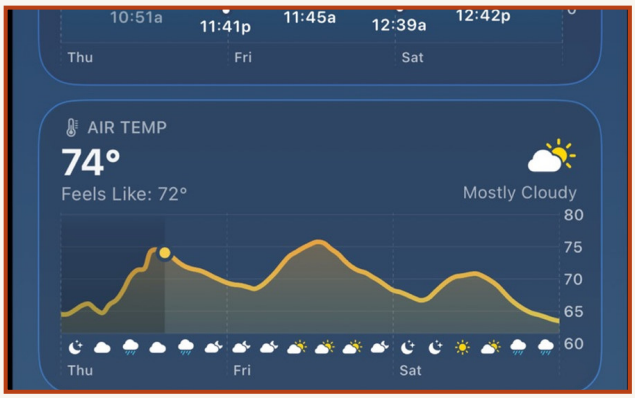
DATA THAT LEADS TO ACTION

Tide Guide

Tide and weather / iOS

Turn information into a next step.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Forecast curves make the next tide readable.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Dense forecast data is layered into readable full-screen charts and widgets.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Start with the time-sensitive answer; reveal detail on demand.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

DATA THAT LEADS TO ACTION

Moonlitt

Moon tracker / iOS

Turn information into a next step.





VISUAL SIGNAL

A lunar calendar turns change into shape.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Onboarding and platform-specific views make astronomy approachable.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Use a strong visual model to explain a changing natural system.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP >

EDITORIAL SOURCE >

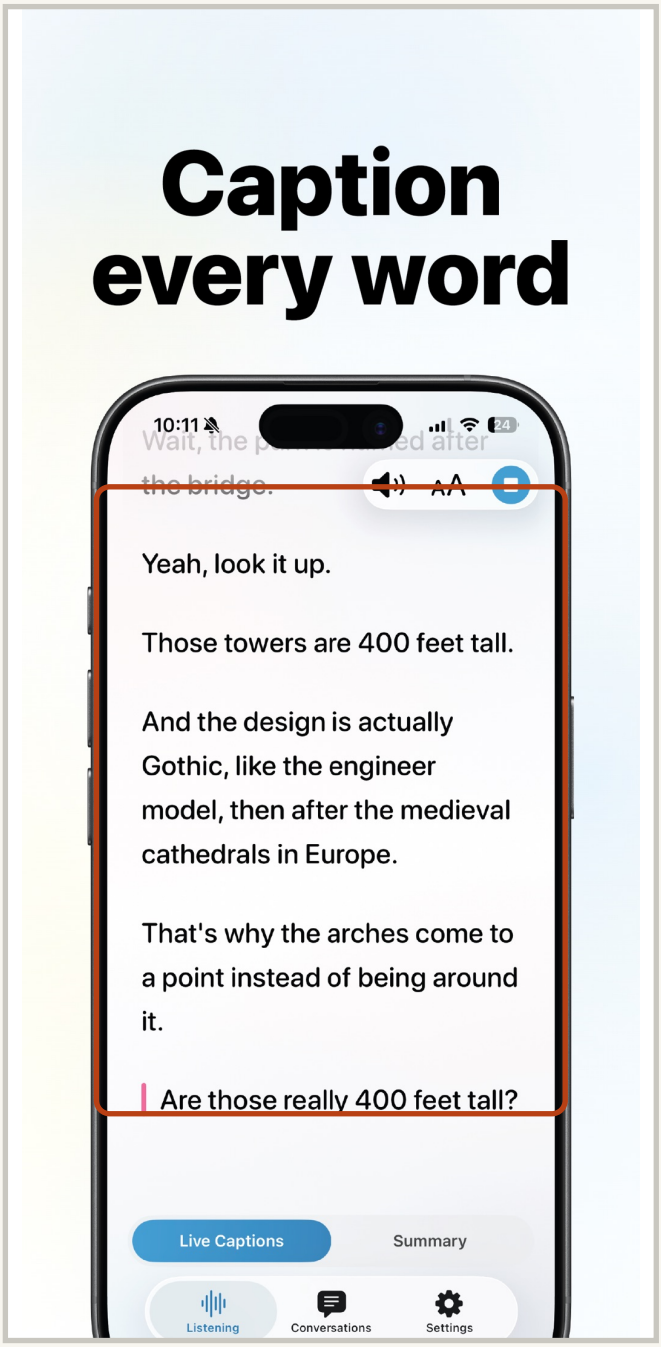
IMAGE SOURCE >

DESIGN FOR MORE PEOPLE

Hearing Buddy

Live captions / iOS

Support different abilities, modalities, and contexts.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Speech becomes large, readable captions.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Conversation captions and Watch alerts address real listening moments.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Put critical information on the device and modality that can reach the user.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

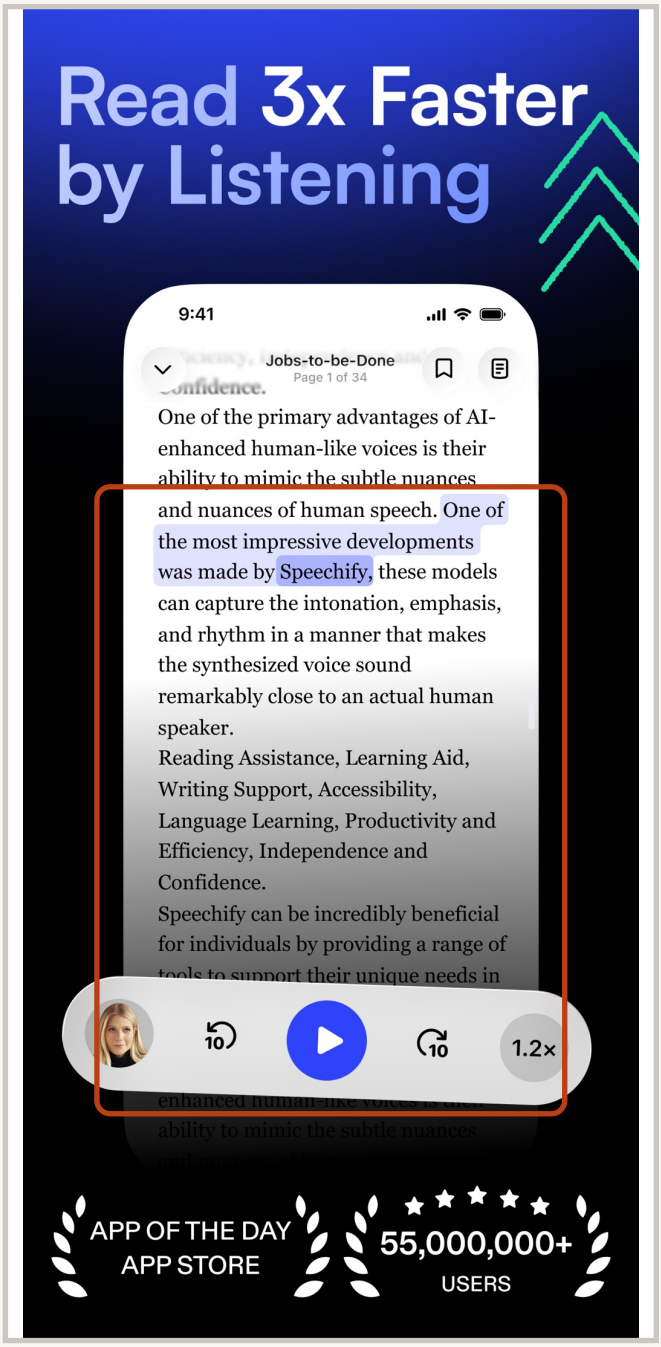
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

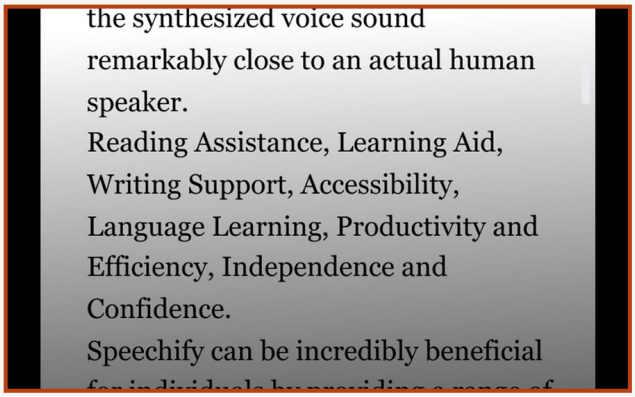
DESIGN FOR MORE PEOPLE

Speechify

Text to audio / iOS

Support different abilities, modalities, and contexts.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Text and playback offer two ways in.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Documents, scans and web pages become listenable through an approachable interface.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Offer alternate input and output modes for the same user task.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING
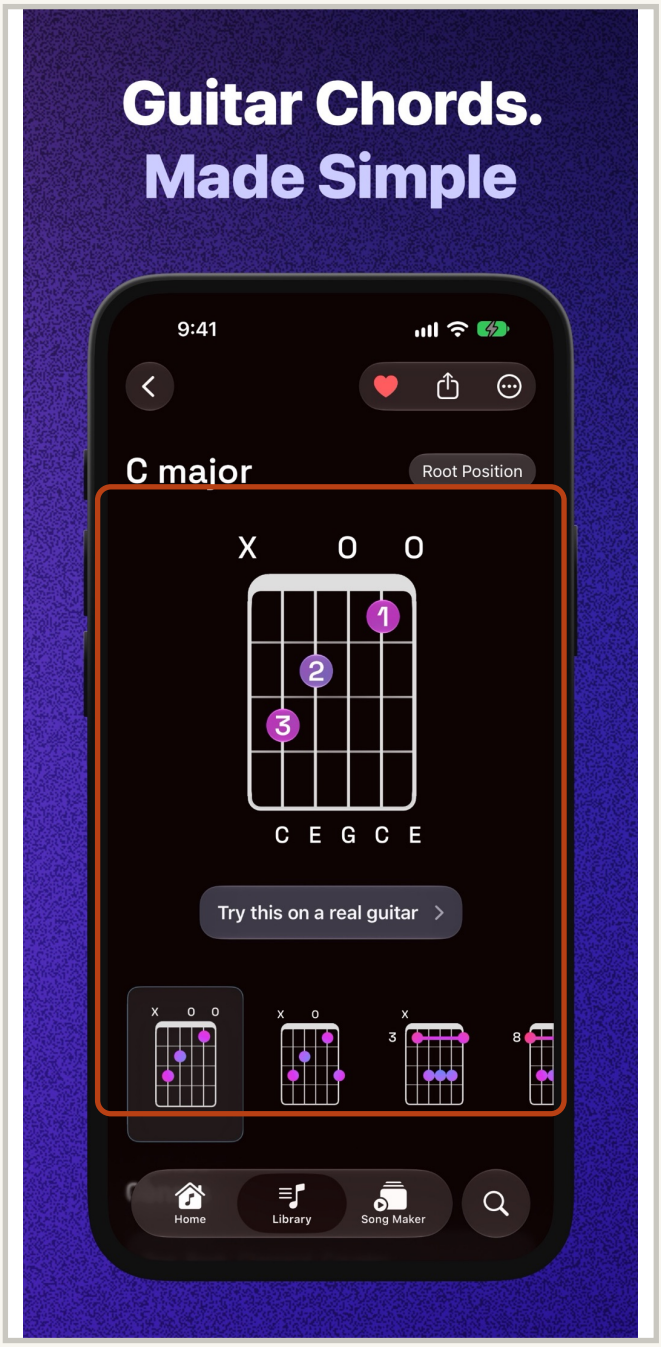
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >
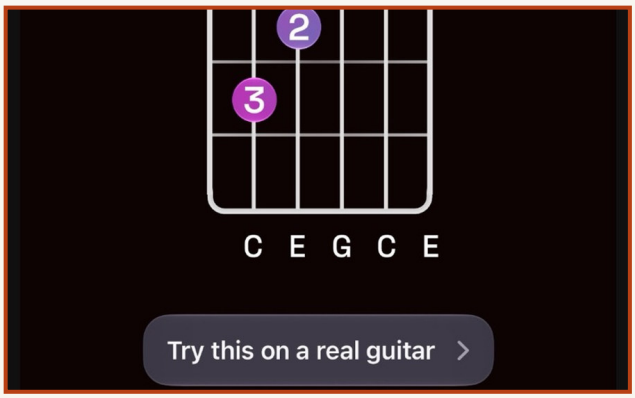
DESIGN FOR MORE PEOPLE

Guitar Wiz

Music utility / iOS

Support different abilities, modalities, and contexts.





VISUAL SIGNAL

A chord diagram gives immediate guidance.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

A large chord diagram makes finger placement a visible learning task.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Pair shape and labels with audio guidance so more people can follow each step.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

DESIGN FOR MORE PEOPLE

Katha Room

Children's stories / iOS

Support different abilities, modalities, and contexts.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Illustration carries the audience's culture.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Folklore-inspired art and sound give familiar bedtime flows a distinct cultural voice.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Make the identity of the audience visible in content and interface details.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

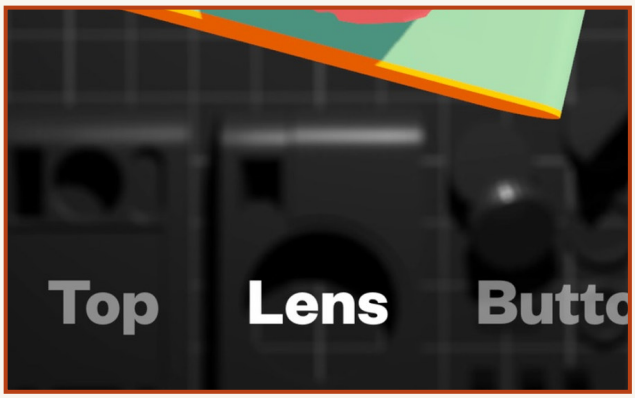
INTERACTION BUILT AROUND THE TASK

(Not Boring) Camera

Camera / iOS

Make the interface fit the user's action and device.





VISUAL SIGNAL

A physical lens metaphor makes settings tangible.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

Oversized lens and color controls make customization feel like handling an object.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Use distinctive interaction where immediate feedback helps mastery.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

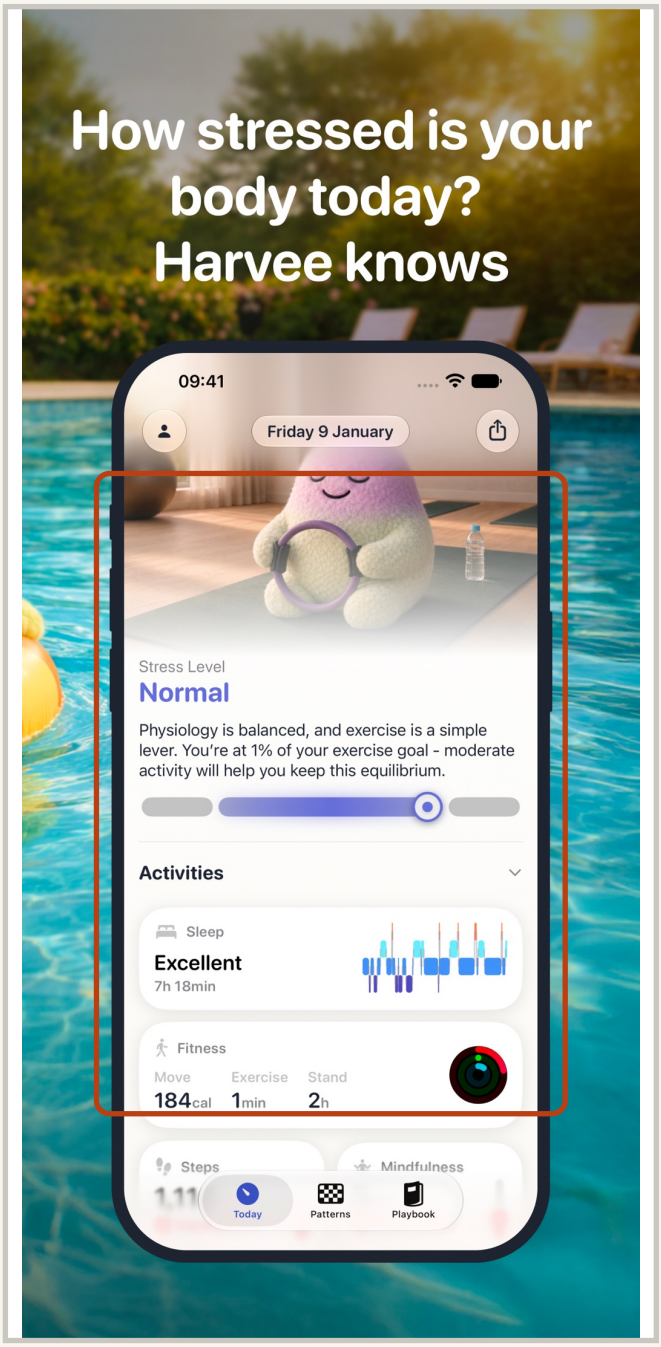
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

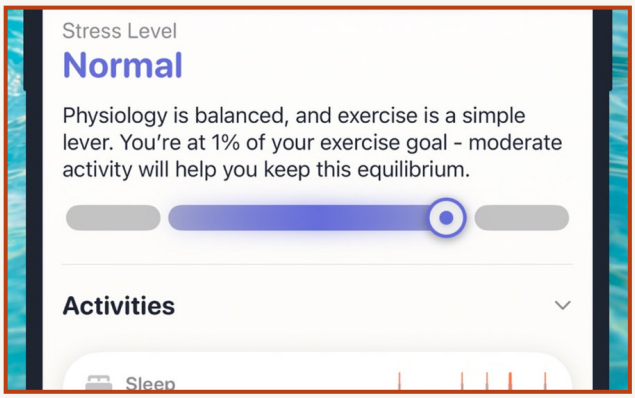
INTERACTION BUILT AROUND THE TASK

Harvee

Recovery companion / iOS

Make the interface fit the user's action and device.





VISUAL SIGNAL

A character gives data a human entry point.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

A small avatar helps interpret heart-rate, sleep and activity signals.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Use a character to humanize a complex state, while keeping the underlying data accessible.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

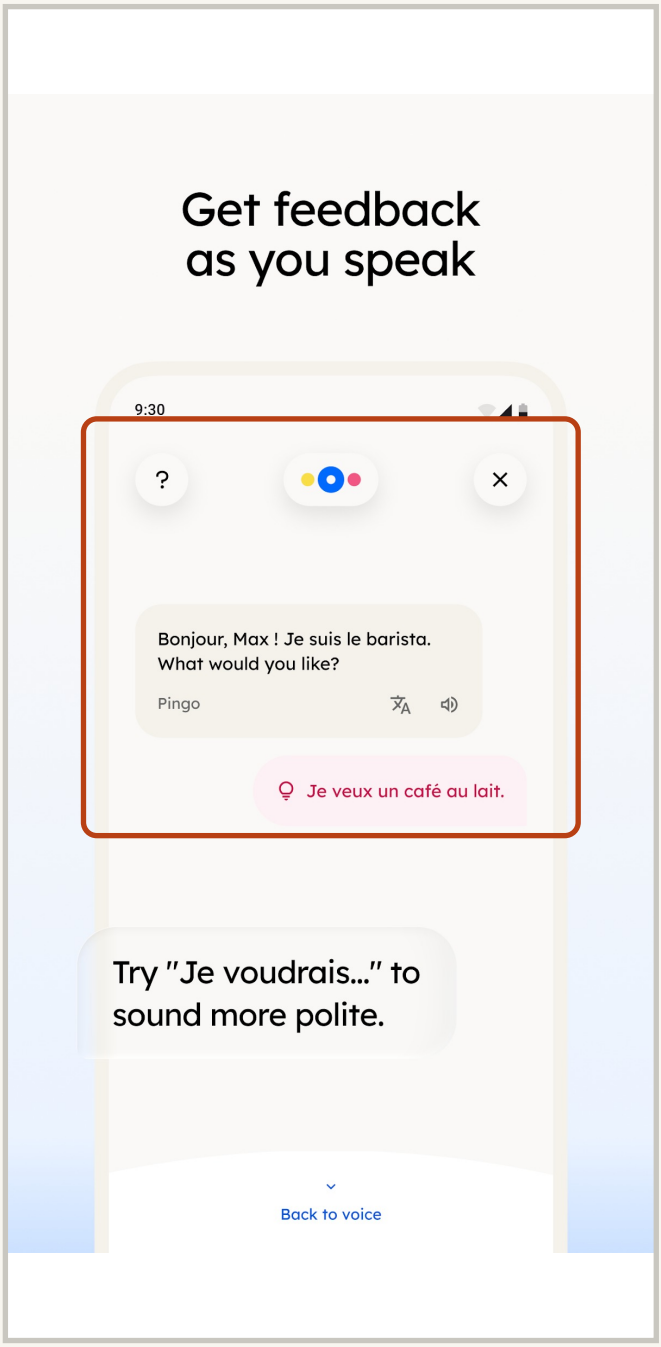
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

INTERACTION BUILT AROUND THE TASK

Pingo AI

Language learning / Android

Make the interface fit the user's action and device.





VISUAL SIGNAL

Speaking feedback appears after the attempt.

WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

A spoken attempt is followed by targeted feedback and another chance to respond.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Design the learning loop around doing, feedback and another attempt.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

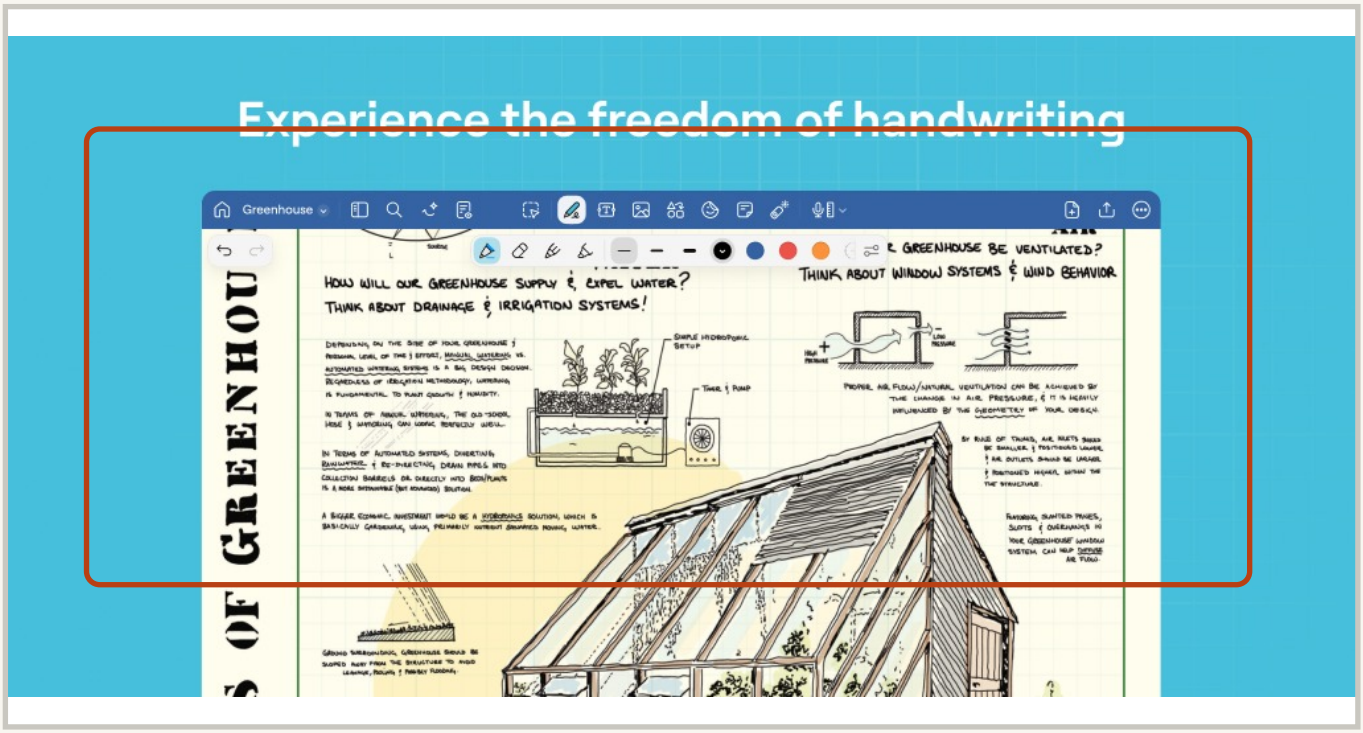
VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

INTERACTION BUILT AROUND THE TASK

Goodnotes

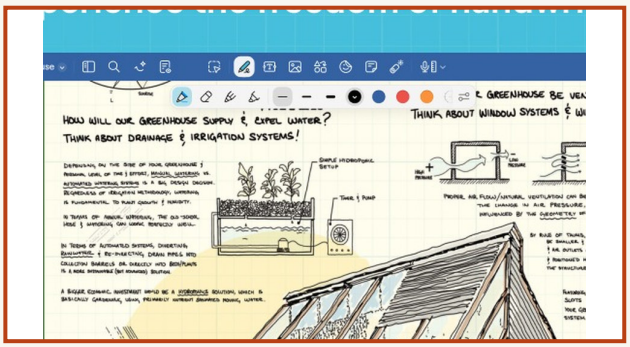
Notes / Android tablets

Make the interface fit the user's action and device.



VISUAL SIGNAL

The canvas uses the tablet's width.



WHAT THE INTERFACE DOES

A large-screen canvas supports handwriting, documents and annotation together.

TRY IN YOUR PRODUCT

Adapt the workspace to the device; do more than stretch a phone layout.

SCREENSHOT: OFFICIAL STORE LISTING

VIEW APP > EDITORIAL SOURCE > IMAGE SOURCE >

FROM INSPIRATION TO ACTION

A five-question design review.

After studying a case, sketch an original version for your users. These prompts turn visual inspiration into a testable design decision.

01 **FIRST VALUE**

Can a new user reach one useful outcome in the first minute?

02 **NEXT ACTION**

Does each screen make the next action clear?

03 **USEFUL DATA**

Are complex results translated into a decision or action?

04 **ACCESS**

Can someone complete the core task with assistive settings?

05 **TASK FIT**

Does the interaction suit the user's task and device?

SOURCES & METHOD

Images are official App Store or Google Play listing screenshots, selected to illustrate one visible interface detail. App screens may change. The observations and transfer ideas are independent editorial interpretation; no product affiliation.